India, making it smarter and greener'. Ashwath Ram, MD, Cummins Group India, added that they are 'making steady progress on [sic] [their] Destination Zero strategy'.

Attending to Emergencies

Despite his new approach of focusing on sustainable philanthropy, Ratan has continued to rush to the aid of the affected families in times of calamity. From the quick relief work undertaken when an earthquake struck Gujarat in 2001 and providing immediate relief to more than 68,000 people to constructing schools, houses, etc., Tata Trusts has reached out whenever the need has arisen.

Such responses in crises are nothing new for the Tatas. It began with Jamsetji who courageously supported the Russian Jew, Dr Waldemar Haffkine, who had developed a vaccine in the 1890s in Bombay to prevent the bubonic plague. The founder's commitment to social cause was so compelling that when Dr Haffkine was subject to a smearing campaign by the West that the serum spread diseases, he quelled the rumour. To build confidence in the common man about both the safety and efficacy of the vaccine, he had himself, his servants and his family members inoculated and was ready to submit to more doses at any point in time.

The founder was so steadfast in furthering the social cause that ten days before Sir Dorabji Tata's marriage, when H.J. Bhabha, a 'professor and an eminent educationist', the father of the bride, arrived in Bombay, he was also made to become an example to the society. Jamsetji virtually left an unsuspecting and somewhat reluctant Bhabha with no choice but to get himself inoculated 'then and there, before all the rest' to 'set an example to others'. On the founder's instructions, his colleague, '[Burjorji] Padshah recruited all the young Parsi students' of St Xavier's to help Haffkine maintain statistical and medical records. Over a century later, the Tatas continue to further this vision and approach to foster a culture of medical research to improve people's health. They have partnered with the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research constituent lab, Institute of Genomics and Integrative Biology, Delhi, for the commercialization of a new testing technology for 'genomic sequence of SARS-CoV-2 virus'.

In 2020, when the Covid-19 pandemic ravaged the globe, the Tatas were amongst the first business houses in India to rush to the assistance of the